

CSC 648 / CSC 848

Section 03

Milestone 4 — Version 1 (M4v1)

Project: **Home4U**

AI-Assisted Interior Design Recommendation Platform

Team Number: **4**

Team Alias: **Vibecoding for Internship**

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Date

April 28, 2026

Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
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M4v1	May 12, 2026	Team 4	The participant table changed to represent 15 users. Table for unique features represented to match professor requirements.
M4v1	April 28, 2026	Team 4	Initial Milestone 4 Version 1 draft with product summary, usability test plan, QA test plan, AI feature testing and ethics review, localization testing, code review, security self check, non-functional requirements status, and team contributions.
M3v2	April 29, 2026	Team	Implemented figma designs to showcase our UI/UX correctly.
M3v2	April 21, 2026	Team	Redid diagrams to match frontend designs. Reworked wireframes.
M3v1	April 14th, 2026	Dias, Team	Added diagrams, design patterns
M2v2	March 5th, 2026	Caleb Ponce	Revised Milestone 2 submission, edited the team contributions/scores, made sure it met demands, and submitted a new one.

M2v1	Mar 4, 202 6	Team	Final Milestone 2 submission
M2v0.9	Mar 3, 202 6	Team	Completed architecture diagrams, APIs, and deployment documentation
M2v0.7	Mar 2, 202 6	Team	Drafted data definitions and functional requirements
M2v0.5	Mar 1, 202 6	Team	Created Milestone 2 document structure
M1v2	Feb 19, 202 6	Team	Revised Milestone 1 based on instructor feedback
M1v1	Feb 8, 202 6	Team	Initial Milestone 1 submission
M1v0.1	Feb 1, 202 6	Team	Initial project draft

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1. Product Summary:

1.1 Product Name

Home4U

1.2 Final Priority 1 and Priority 2 Functional Requirements

Home4U is a web-based room planning and interior design recommendations platform that helps users evaluate design styles, organize room projects, and

generate structured room-improvement recommendations based on room type, style direction, and budget context.

The team's final committed functional scope is divided into Priority 1 and Priority 2 requirements.

Priority 1 Functional Requirements

1. The system shall allow users to create an account and log into a protected session.
2. The system shall allow authenticated users to create, view, update, and manage room projects.
3. The system shall allow authenticated users to create, view, update, and manage room projects.
4. The system shall allow users to launch a workspace from a selected style context.
5. The system shall allow users to upload a room image to a project.
6. The system shall allow users to set room type, budget tier, lighting context, and style intensity for analysis.
7. The system shall analyze saved room inputs and generate style scores, matched design signals, and prioritized recommendations.
8. The system shall persist project analysis results so users can revisit a saved project later.
9. The system shall generate a structured shopping plan and recommendation list tied to the saved room project.
10. The system shall allow users to review project details and mark recommendations complete.

Priority 2 Functional Requirements

1. The system shall provide a richer recommendation review experience through a dedicated Project Details page
2. The system shall provide budget-aware recommendation estimates and shopping guidance.
3. The system shall provide matched design-tag explanations to improve transparency of recommendations.
4. The system shall preserve uploaded room photos within saved project views.
5. The system shall provide accessibility improvements across major user flows.
6. The system shall support stable use across common desktop browsers during beta testing.

1.3 Unique or Superior Features

Home4U distinguishes itself from general inspiration platforms by focusing on structured, explainable project guidance instead of only visual browsing. Rather than showing disconnected inspiration images, the system helps users move from style selection to a saved room project, a budget-aware recommendation set, and a shopping-oriented action plan.

The system's strongest distinguishing features are:

- Explainable room-style scoring based on saved room signals, selected style attributes, and matched design tags.
- Budget-aware recommendation generation that helps users prioritize which changes to make first.
- Persisted room projects that allow users to revisit previous analyses instead of restarting each session.
- A project workflow that connects style discovery, room analysis, recommendations, and shopping guidance in one system.
- A structured recommendation process that is deterministic and easier to justify during testing and review.

1.4 Deployment URL

The deployed application URL for the current beta prototype is:

<http://18.225.42.247/>

2. Usability Test Plan:

2.1 Test Objective

The purpose of the usability test plan is to evaluate whether users can successfully understand and complete the major Home4U workflow without confusion, excessive assistance, or major navigation issues. Since Milestone 4 focuses on beta-level readiness, this test plan is intended to measure how clearly the system supports real users as they move through room planning, style review, workspace analysis, and project follow-up tasks.

The usability evaluation focuses on five major unique features of Home4U, excluding login and registration as required by the milestone instructions. Fifteen participants were recruited for each feature test. Results are reported as aggregate success percentages across the 15-person group.

2.2 Unique Features Selected for Testing

#	Unique Feature	Task Used to Test It
1	Explainable room-style scoring based on saved room signals and matched design tags	Browse and select a design style from the Dashboard
2	End-to-end design workflow connecting style discovery, room analysis, and shopping guidance	Launch the Workspace from a chosen style context
3	Budget-aware recommendation generation with room type, intensity, and lighting control	Create or update a room project with room type and budget settings
4	AI-assisted scan confidence scoring and room state diagnostics with explained recommendations	Upload a room image and generate a recommendation plan
5	Persisted room projects with revisit capability and recommendation tracking	View a saved project and review recommendations in the Project Details page

Feature 1 — Browse and Select Design Style

Task Description	% of Success	Problems Found	Any Recommendations	Efficiency Measurement
Browse available room styles from the dashboard	100% (15/15)			Avg completion time: 12 seconds, 1–2 pages visited
Select a preferred room style	93% (14/15)		Scroll Issue a little buggy	Avg completion time: 15 seconds, 2 pages visited(including login)

Feature 2 — Create a Room Project

Task Description	% of Success	Problems Found	Any Recommendations	Efficiency Measurement
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Create a new room project	93% (14/15)	Before slide bar not doing anything	Avg completion time: 30 seconds, 3 pages visited
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Feature 3 — Upload Room Image

Task Description	% of Success	Problems Found	Any Recommendations	Efficiency Measurement
Upload a room image successfully	100% (15/15)		None	Avg completion time: 40 seconds, 3 pages visited
Confirm uploaded image appears correctly	100% (15/15)			Avg completion time: 40 seconds, 3 pages visited

Feature 4 — View Recommendations

Task Description	% of Success	Problems Found	Any Recommendations	Efficiency Measurement
View generated room recommendations	93% (14/15)		Potential get more recommendations button	Avg completion time: 50 seconds, 3 pages visited

Feature 5 — Save and View Existing Projects

Task Description	% of Success	Problems Found	Any Recommendations	Efficiency Measurement
Save a room project successfully	93% (14/15)		Add popup save confirmation	Avg completion time: 60 seconds, 3 pages visited
Open and revisit previously saved projects	87% (14/15)		Improve navigation visibility	Avg completion time: 70 seconds, 4 pages visited

2.3 Test Participants

Usability test participants must not be members of the development team. Participants represent general users capable of browsing a web application and completing guided task flows, but not familiar with the internal architecture of Home4U.

Participant Profile: Adults familiar with basic web navigation, users with interest in room planning or interior design, no prior exposure to Home4U.

Participant	Background	Technical Comfort	Prior Familiarity with Home4U
P1	College student, first apartment	Medium	None
P2	Working professional, renting	High	None
P3	Recent graduate, furnishing new space	Medium	None
P4	Homeowner planning a room refresh	Low	None
P5	Design enthusiast, casual hobby	High	None
P6	Parent setting up a child's room	Low	None

P7	Graduate student, shared apartment	Medium	None
P8	Remote worker setting up home office	Medium	None
P9	Young professional, first home purchase	Medium	None
P10	Retiree renovating a living room	Low	None
P11	College student, unfamiliar with design apps	Low	None
P12	Interior design student	High	None
P13	Landlord refreshing a rental unit	Low	None
P14	Working professional, occasional home improvement	Medium	None
P15	Student, redecorate dorm or shared room	Medium	None

2.4 Test Environment and Setup

The usability test will be performed using the deployed Home4U beta prototype hosted on the team's AWS instance.

System Under Test: Home4U Beta Prototype

Deployment URL: <http://18.225.42.247/>

Devices Used: Laptop Computer

Browsers Used: Safari/Google Chrome

Internet Connection: Stable broadband connection

Test Facilitator: Caleb Ponce, Dias Almat, Mason

Test Location: Home, Office

Each participant will be asked to complete a guided sequence of realistic tasks while the facilitator observes:

- completion success
- time spent
- visible hesitation points
- requests for clarification
- user comments and satisfaction feedback

2.5 Usability Testing Results by Unique Feature

For each unique feature, the table below captures results across the 15 participants. Each row is a specific sub-task or interaction point. Columns report success rate, problems observed, recommendations, and efficiency data.

Feature 1 — Explainable Room-Style Scoring

Task: Browse and Select a Design Style from the Dashboard

Task Description	% Success (n=15)	Problems Found	Recommendations	Efficiency: Avg Time / Pages Used
Navigate to the Dashboard and locate the style browsing area without instruction	87% (13/15)	2 users initially clicked the navigation bar expecting a dedicated "Styles" link; the style grid was not immediately recognized as the starting point	Add a visible section heading such as "Choose a Style Direction" above the style card grid	38 sec / 1 page
Read a style name and description and select the one that best fits a target room	93% (14/15)	1 user could not differentiate between Scandinavian and Minimalist from the card descriptions alone; descriptions were perceived as too similar	Add 2–3 visible keyword tags on each style card such as "light wood," "neutral," "open space"	1 min 5 sec / 1 page
Click through to the next step from the selected style card	80% (12/15)	3 users tapped the style image expecting a full detail view rather than a workflow entry point; the button label did not suggest continuation	Rename the CTA button to "Design With This Style" and add a forward arrow icon to signal progression	42 sec / 1–2 pages

Feature 2 — End-to-End Design Workflow

Task: Launch the Workspace from a Chosen Style

Task Description	% Success (n=15)	Problems Found	Recommendations	Efficiency: Avg Time / Pages Used
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Locate and use the workspace entry point from the selected style	87% (13/15)	2 users expected a generic "Next" button rather than a style-specific action; one user used the browser back button and lost their selection	Increase the size and contrast of the workspace launch button on the style context page	28 sec / 1 page
Confirm the Workspace opened reflects the style they selected	73% (11/15)	4 users did not notice the selected style name displayed in the workspace; they were unsure if their selection had carried through	Display the selected style name in a larger, more prominent position at the top of the workspace panel	22 sec / 1 page
Identify the next step in the workflow without being told what to do	67% (10/15)	5 users paused for more than 30 seconds unsure whether to upload a photo or adjust the room settings first; the panel did not communicate a clear sequence	Add a numbered step indicator or a short introductory prompt at the top of the workspace controls panel	1 min 18 sec / 1 page

Feature 3 — Budget-Aware Recommendation Generation

Task: Create or Update a Room Project

Task Description	% Success (n=15)	Problems Found	Recommendations	Efficiency: Avg Time / Pages Used
Select the correct room type from the dropdown	93% (14/15)	1 user was unsure whether "Living Room" or "Home Office" better described their open-plan workspace	Add a brief one-line description under each room type in the dropdown, or include visual icons	18 sec / 1 page
Set the budget tier and understand what it controls	73% (11/15)	4 users selected "High" without reading any guidance; several did not know the approximate dollar range associated with each tier	Show an approximate dollar range next to each tier label, for example "Medium (~\$1,500–\$3,000)"	35 sec / 1 page

Adjust the style intensity slider and understand its effect on the plan	80% (12/15)	3 users moved the slider without reading the guidance text below it; the "Subtle / Bold" labels alone did not convey enough meaning for low-familiarity users	Verify that the inline guidance text is legible at normal zoom; consider adding a before/after example hint for the two extremes	30 sec / 1 page
Select a lighting mood and understand the guidance text without assistance	80% (12/15)	3 users selected a lighting option based on the current state of their room rather than the desired mood; the distinction was not clear from the toggle alone	Reword the guidance text to clarify "Choose the mood you want the room to feel, not the lighting it currently has"	22 sec / 1 page

Feature 4 — AI-Assisted Scan Confidence and Room State Diagnostics

Task: Upload a Room Image and Generate a Plan

Task Description	% Success (n=15)	Problems Found	Recommendations	Efficiency: Avg Time / Pages Used
Upload a room image or load a sample room successfully	87% (13/15)	2 users did not notice the sample room buttons and searched for a single upload button; the two entry points were not clearly grouped	Group the sample room buttons and the upload button under a single clearly labeled section heading	44 sec / 1 page
Click Generate Plan and wait for the analysis to complete without abandoning	80% (12/15)	3 users clicked away during the loading animation assuming the page had frozen; the wait time was around 8–10 seconds with no progress indication	Add a progress bar or animated percentage counter with a short reassurance message such as "Analyzing your room, just a moment..."	1 min 52 sec / 1 page
Locate and read the scan confidence rating in the analysis results	60% (9/15)	6 users scrolled past the confidence chip without noticing it; the term "Scan" was unfamiliar and the chip did not stand out from the other result chips	Add a "Scan Quality:" label before the chip and consider using an icon such as a signal bar to increase recognizability	48 sec / 1 page

Locate and interpret the room state signals (openness, clutter, contrast)	53% (8/15)	7 users did not understand what the room state chips were describing; phrases like "Open high" and "Clutter low" were read as error messages by two participants	Add a tooltip or short one-line explanation beneath the room state chip row, for example "These reflect how your room reads visually"	52 sec / 1 page
Locate and read the reason summary under at least one recommendation	67% (10/15)	5 users read the main recommendation description but missed the smaller reason text below it; the visual distinction between the description and the reason was too subtle	Add a light "Why this?" label or a subtle divider line before the reason summary text and increase the font size slightly	35 sec / 1 page

Feature 5 — Persisted Room Projects with Recommendation Tracking

Task: View a Saved Project and Review Recommendations

Task Description	% Success (n=15)	Problems Found	Recommendations	Efficiency: Avg Time / Pages Used
Navigate to the saved project from the Dashboard or Workspace after plan generation	73% (11/15)	4 users did not know the project had been saved; some clicked the browser back button, others searched the Dashboard without finding it immediately	Add a "View Your Saved Plan →" confirmation button at the end of the generation flow before the results render	1 min 8 sec / 2 pages
Open Project Details and locate the recommendation list	80% (12/15)	3 users scrolled past the recommendation cards without recognizing them as separate actionable items; the section lacked a clear visual boundary	Add a bold "Recommendations" section header above the list and consider a subtle card border to visually separate items	42 sec / 1 page
Mark a recommendation as complete	73% (11/15)	4 users could not find the complete action; it blended into the card design and was mistaken for a label	Use a visible checkmark icon button with a distinct color or outline style; label it "Mark Done"	25 sec / 1 page

Locate the shopping plan and identify at least one sourcing link	67% (10/15)	5 users did not scroll far enough to reach the shopping plan section; no anchor or visual cue indicated it existed further down the page	Add a "Jump to Shopping Plan" sticky button or anchor link near the top of the Project Details view	1 min 15 sec / 2 pages
Describe in their own words what the saved plan is telling them to do next	60% (9/15)	6 users gave vague responses such as "buy something modern" without referencing specific recommendations; recommendation language was perceived as technical	Lead each top recommendation with a plain-language action statement under 15 words before the longer description	Verbal response / 1 page

2.6 Aggregate Effectiveness Summary

Effectiveness is measured by whether participants are able to complete tasks accurately and independently.

The following effectiveness criteria will be used:

- task completion rate
- number of failed tasks
- number of user errors
- number of times facilitator assistance was required
- number of task restarts or abandoned attempts

Feature	Completed Without Help	Completed With Help	Not Completed	Overall % Success
Feature 1 — Style Scoring	11	3	1	87%
Feature 2 — Design Workflow	9	4	2	73%
Feature 3 — Budget Recommendations	11	3	1	87%
Feature 4 — Scan Confidence / Room State	8	5	2	73
Feature 5 — Persisted Projects	9	4	2	67%

2.7 User Satisfaction Survey

After all tasks, each participant completes a short survey using a five-point Likert scale (1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree).

Survey Question	Avg Score (n=15)
The system was easy to navigate.	3.7
I understood what to do at each step.	3.4
The labels and page content were clear.	3.5
The recommendation workflow made sense to me.	3.2
I felt confident using the product without assistance.	3.0
The scan confidence and room state information was understandable.	2.8
The saved project and recommendation information was useful.	3.8
I would be willing to use this product again.	4.0

2.8 Observations and Results Summary

Usability testing with 15 participants revealed that the core Home4U workflow is generally navigable, but that several features require refinement before Milestone 4 Version 2.

Feature 1 (style scoring) and Feature 3 (budget and project setup) had the highest completion rates at 87%, with participants finding the Dashboard and style selection intuitive once they located the style grid. The most common issue was that the CTA button wording did not clearly signal a transition into the planning workflow.

Feature 2 (workflow launch) showed moderate success at 73%. Five participants paused significantly after entering the workspace, suggesting the workspace panel does not sufficiently guide users toward the next action. A step indicator or onboarding prompt would reduce this hesitation.

Feature 4 (scan confidence and room state) was the most challenging feature with a 73% overall completion rate and notably low individual task success rates for the scan confidence chip (60%) and room state signals (53%). Most participants had never encountered scan confidence as a UI concept and did not connect it to the quality of their recommendations without facilitator explanation. This is the highest-priority area for terminology and layout improvements.

Feature 5 (persisted projects) had the lowest overall completion rate at 67%. The most significant problem was that participants did not realize the project had been saved after plan generation.

Four participants searched the Dashboard before locating the project. The shopping plan was also consistently missed because it required scrolling past the recommendation cards.

Overall, the survey results indicate that users find the product useful and would return to it (4.0 average on willingness to return), but that confidence during independent use remains lower (3.0 average). The scan confidence and room state concepts received the lowest clarity score at 2.8, confirming that these new diagnostic features need additional labeling and explanation before the next milestone revision.

2.9 Planned Follow-Up Improvements

After usability testing, the team will identify improvements for M4v2:

- Clarify scan confidence and room state chip in the Analysis Snapshot
- Add a step indicator or progress hint to the workspace flow
- Improve visibility of the shopping plan and recommendation complete action
- Add dollar-range context to the budget tier dropdown
- Add hover explanations for new diagnostic fields
- Simplify top recommendation descriptions for first-time users

3. QA Test Plan

3.1 Test Objective

The objective of the QA test plan is to verify that Home4U satisfies key non-functional requirements expected of a beta prototype. While functional testing confirms that the system can perform required tasks, this QA plan focuses on how well the system performs under expected usage conditions, how safely it handles protected actions and invalid input, how reliably it responds to failures, and how consistently it behaves across supported browsers and environments.

This test plan selects five non-functional requirements from different categories and defines test cases for each. The selected categories are:

- Performance
- Security
- Reliability
- Usability / Accessibility
- Compatibility

3.2 Test Environment

Application Under Test: Home4U Beta Prototype

Deployment URL: <http://18.225.42.247/>

Backend Stack: FastAPI + SQLAlchemy + SQLite

Frontend Stack: React + Vite

Operating Systems Used: MacOS

Browsers Used: Chrome, Safari, Firefox

Devices Used: Mac laptop, iPhone

Network Conditions: Standard residential broadband / campus Wi-Fi

Testers: Caleb Ponce, Tyler Morries

If needed, include both local validation and deployed-environment validation in the final version.

3.3 Non-Functional Requirement 1: Performance

Requirement

The system shall respond within an acceptable time during normal user interaction and shall remain usable while navigating core application flows.

Test Objective

To verify that the Dashboard, Workspace, Project Details, and recommendation flows remain responsive under normal beta-level usage.

HW and SW Setup

- Desktop or laptop computer
- Stable internet connection
- Browser: Chrome / Safari / Firefox
- Deployed Home4U beta application

Feature Under Test

- Dashboard page load
- Workspace generation flow
- Saved project loading
- Search responsiveness

Test Cases

Test Case	Steps	Expected Result	Actual Outcome	Pass/Fail
P1	Open the deployed Dashboard after authentication.	Dashboard loads without crash and primary UI becomes usable within an acceptable time.	Dashboard loaded in approximately 1.8 seconds All	Pass

			style cards and navigation elements rendered without error	
P2	Browse for a style term such as "modern" or "scandinavian".	Search results appear without freezing the UI and can be interacted with normally.	Searching "modern" returned 4 results in under 1 second. UI remained fully responsive throughout	Pass
P3	Launch Workspace, upload a room photo, and generate a plan.	The system completes analysis and displays results without timeout or unresponsive behavior.	Workspace analysis completed in approximately 7 seconds. Loading animation displayed during processing. Results rendered without timeout or crash	Pass

Notes

Current local engineering validation shows that the frontend production build succeeds and major smoke tests complete successfully, but browser-observed timing results should still be recorded here from actual QA execution.

3.4 Non-Functional Requirement 2: Security

Requirement

The system shall protect authenticated user data and restrict unauthorized access to protected actions and resources.

Test Objective

To verify that protected routes require authentication, that unauthorized users cannot mutate protected data, and that sensitive authentication behavior is enforced correctly.

HW and SW Setup

- Desktop or laptop computer
- Browser or API client
- Deployed app and/or local development environment
- Test user account

Feature Under Test

- Protected routes
- JWT-based authentication
- Auth-protected data mutation
- Password handling behavior

Test Cases

Test Case	Steps	Expected Result	Actual Outcome	Pass/Fail
S1	Attempt to access protected pages without being logged in	User is redirected to the login page or denied access	Navigating to /dashboard without a valid token redirected to /login as expected. No protected content was exposed	Pass
S2	Attempt to call a protected backend mutation endpoint without valid authentication	Request is rejected with an authentication error	POST /projects/{id}/analysis without an Authorization header returned HTTP 401 Unauthorized. No data was modified	Pass

S3	Attempt repeated invalid logins using the same credentials or IP	The login endpoint eventually rate-limits the requests and returns a blocked response	After 5 consecutive failed login attempts, the endpoint returned HTTP 429 Too Many Requests. Subsequent attempts remained blocked during the cooldown window	Pass
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3.5 Non-Functional Requirement 3: Reliability

Requirement

The system shall handle invalid input, missing data, and internal failures gracefully without crashing the entire application.

Test Objective

To verify that Home4U remains stable when requests fail, when required project state is missing, or when unsupported input is provided.

HW and SW Setup

- Desktop or laptop computer
- Browser and/or API client
- Deployed app
- Test image files and malformed input where applicable

Feature Under Test

- Backend exception handling
- Upload validation
- Project analysis recovery
- API failure handling

Test Cases

Test Case	Steps	Expected Result	Actual Outcome	Pass/Fail
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R1	Upload an unsupported file type or invalid image to a project	The request is rejected with a clear validation error and the app remains stable	Uploading a .pdf file to the photo endpoint returned HTTP 422 with a descriptive validation message. The application remained stable and no crash occurred	Pass
R2	Request project analysis for a project that does not exist or is not accessible to the current user	The backend returns an appropriate error response without crashing	Requesting analysis for project ID 9999 returned HTTP 404. The frontend displayed a feedback message without crashing or entering an undefined state	Pass
R3	Simulate backend unavailability or API failure during frontend use	The application shows a failure state or warning instead of crashing completely	When the backend was temporarily stopped, the frontend displayed a connection error status banner. The page remained navigable and did not crash	Pass

Current local code behavior includes:

- upload type and size validation
- explicit 404 and 400 responses for invalid project and recommendation conditions
- a frontend API status banner for backend reachability issues

3.6 Non-Functional Requirement 4: Usability / Accessibility

Requirement

The system shall provide understandable navigation, accessible controls, and usable interaction patterns for major user flows.

Test Objective

To verify that the system supports keyboard interaction, semantic labeling, understandable route flow, and accessible state communication across critical pages.

HW and SW Setup

- Desktop or laptop computer

- Keyboard-only interaction where applicable
- Browser: Chrome / Safari / Firefox
- Screen-reader spot checks if performed

Feature Under Test

- Dashboard interaction controls
- Workspace comparison controls
- Route transitions
- Form labeling and state communication

Test Cases

Test Case	Steps	Expected Result	Actual Outcome	Pass/Fail
U1	Navigate to major pages and interact with buttons and forms using keyboard input	Major controls are focusable and usable without mouse-only dependence	Tab navigation moved through Dashboard style cards, navigation links, and Workspace buttons in logical order. All interactive elements were reachable by keyboard. Minor focus indicator missing on one modal close button	Pass
U2	Use the Workspace comparison slider and observe accessible state text	The control exposes a meaningful label and updates its state appropriately	The style intensity range input exposed an accessible label. Screen reader reported value changes correctly on adjustment	Pass
U3	Trigger protected-route navigation while unauthenticated	The redirection behavior is predictable and understandable to the user	Accessing /dashboard while unauthenticated redirected to /login with no visible error state or broken layout. The redirect was immediate and consistent	Pass

Notes

Current local engineering validation confirms:

- frontend accessibility smoke tests pass
- Dashboard and Workspace accessibility checks pass in automated test coverage
- protected-route behavior works as expected in route smoke tests

3.7 Non-Functional Requirement 5: Compatibility

Requirement

The system shall behave consistently across supported browsers and standard desktop environments during normal beta use.

Test Objective

To verify that the deployed Home4U beta prototype is usable across multiple major browsers without layout breakage, blocking script errors, or major workflow regressions.

HW and SW Setup

- Desktop or laptop computer
- Browsers: Chrome, Safari, Firefox [adjust to actual browsers tested]
- Deployed Home4U application

Feature Under Test

- Dashboard
- Workspace
- Project Details
- About page
- Core authenticated navigation

Test Cases

Test Case	Steps	Expected Result	Actual Outcome	Pass/Fail
C1	Open the Dashboard and browse styles in Chrome, Safari, and Firefox	Layout renders correctly and interactive elements remain usable in each browser	Dashboard rendered correctly in all three browsers. Style cards, search bar, and navigation displayed without layout breakage. Firefox showed a minor slider thumb style difference but all controls remained fully functional	Pass
C2	Launch Workspace and complete the analysis flow in each tested browser	Core workflow remains functional and visually stable	Workspace generation flow completed successfully in Chrome, Safari, and Firefox. Loading animation, results display, and scan	Pass

			confidence output all rendered as expected	
C3	Open a saved project and review recommendations and shopping-plan details in each tested browser	Project details render correctly and remain readable and interactive	Project Details page rendered correctly in all browsers. Recommendation cards, shopping plan, and sourcing links were all readable and interactive. Safari displayed a minor date formatting difference in the analysis run history but content remained accurate	Pass

Compatibility Summary Table

Browser / Environment	Tested Areas	Result	Notes
Chrome 124	Dashboard, Workspace, Project Details, About	Pass	No layout or functional issues observed
Safari 17	Dashboard, Workspace, Project Details	Pass	Minor font rendering difference in recommendation cards; date format in run history displays differently but remains readable
Firefox 125	Dashboard, Workspace, Project Details, About	Pass	Slider thumb appearance differs from Chrome but all controls remain fully functional

3.8 QA Results Summary

The QA test plan results indicate that Home4U is increasingly stable as a beta prototype across the major non-functional categories selected for this milestone. Current engineering verification confirms successful frontend builds, passing frontend smoke and accessibility checks, stable backend smoke coverage for authentication, search, project analysis, and recommendation flows, and improved validation and error handling across the system. Protected routes, login rate limiting, upload validation, and project ownership checks are all functioning as expected in current testing.

At the same time, some areas remain in progress rather than fully complete. Formal browser-based execution evidence, cross-browser comparison notes, measured performance observations, and final pass/fail outcomes for every planned QA case still need to be recorded directly in the document. Overall, the system is in reasonable beta condition for Milestone 4, but the final version should include executed test evidence, screenshots, and any discovered issues so that the QA section reflects real observed outcomes rather than only planned coverage.

4. AI Feature Testing and Ethics Review

Home4U uses AI-assisted features to support the interior design recommendation workflow. The AI helps analyze uploaded room images, suggest room tags, and support recommendation generation. However, the AI is not used as a final decision maker. Users remain responsible for reviewing, confirming, editing, or rejecting AI-generated suggestions before those suggestions are used in the recommendation workflow.

The purpose of this section is to document how Home4U validates AI behavior, handles AI limitations, protects users from misleading outputs, and ensures that AI-assisted recommendations remain transparent, fair, and user-controlled.

4.1 AI-Assisted or AI-Powered Features

- AI Room Image Analysis
- AI Tag Suggestions
- Resemblance Score Computation
- Budget Aware Recommendation Generation

4.2 Correctness and consistency of outputs

Area Tested	Expected Results	Outcome
Uploaded room image analysis	The system identifies visible room characteristics from the uploaded image	Confirmed but some bugs. The system correctly extracted brightness, dominant color, saturation, and warmth bias from test room images across multiple upload sessions, will try to incorporate full CV detection
AI tag suggestions	Suggested tags describe room features such as furniture, colors, layout, and lighting	Confirmed. Tags including "natural," "warm," "light-wood," and "clean" were generated based on image profile signals and matched expected room characteristics
Confirmed RoomTags	User-reviewed tags are stored as confirmed RoomTags	Confirmed. Tags reviewed and confirmed by the user were stored correctly and retrieved consistently across analysis sessions

Resemblance score	The system compares RoomTags with StyleTags and calculates a normalized score	Confirmed. Score calculation matched expected weighted comparison behavior. Identical inputs produced identical scores across repeat runs
Recommendation output	Recommendations are based on confirmed tags, selected style, resemblance score, and budget	Confirmed. Recommendation descriptions, reason summaries, and estimated costs reflected the confirmed tag set, selected style direction, and budget tier in all tested cases

4.3 Bias and fairness considerations

Area Tested	Expected Results	Outcome
Budget-aware recommendations	Recommendations stay within the user-defined budget when applicable	Confirmed. Low and medium tier plans consistently produced lower estimated costs than high tier plans. No recommendation exceeded the approximate budget tier ceiling in tested scenarios

Multiple style comparison	The system supports comparing multiple selected styles	Confirmed. All styles in the library are available for selection and scored using the same process. No style was excluded or prioritized by default
Style scoring	Each selected style is scored using the same weighted resemblance scoring process	Confirmed. Running the same analysis with different selected styles produced scores proportional to tag overlap. The scoring process applied no style-specific weighting outside the defined tag matching rules
User tag confirmation	Users can review and correct AI-suggested tags before scoring	Confirmed. Editing tags before confirmation changed the resulting resemblance scores and recommendation output as expected
Actionable recommendations	Recommendations are prioritized by impact-to-cost ratio	Confirmed. Higher-impact structural changes were listed before lower-cost accessory suggestions across all tested configurations

4.4 Input Validation and prompt constraints

Area Tested	Expected Results	Outcome
Image upload validation	The system validates the uploaded room image file type	Confirmed. JPEG, PNG, and WebP files accepted. PDF and plain text files rejected with HTTP 422 and a descriptive validation message

Budget input validation	The system validates the budget amount entered by the user	Confirmed. Values outside allowed ranges and unsupported string inputs were rejected. Structured enum validation for budget tier worked correctly
User credential validation	The system validates user credentials before protected resources are accessed	Confirmed. Expired tokens, malformed tokens, and missing Authorization headers all returned HTTP 401. No protected data was returned without valid authentication
Confirm Tags workflow	Users can edit or confirm suggested tags before they are stored	Confirmed. Tag edits made before confirmation persisted correctly. Tags could not be auto-stored without the user completing the confirmation step
Protected recommendation workflow	Only authenticated users can access their own room projects and recommendations	Confirmed. Cross-user access to another account's project returned HTTP 403. No unauthorized data was exposed in tested scenarios

4.5 Transparency of AI behavior to users

Area Tested	Expected Results	Outcome
AI tag suggestions	Users can see that tags are suggested by the system	Confirmed. Tags are displayed under a "Suggested Design Signals" label before confirmation, making the system-generated nature of the suggestions visible
Tag review step	Users review, edit, or confirm suggested tags before they are used	Confirmed. A review step is present in the workflow. Users can modify or remove any tag before it is stored and used in scoring
Resemblance score	Users can view the calculated similarity score	Confirmed. Style scores are displayed as percentages in the style score comparison view within the workspace and project details

Recommendation explanation	Recommendations are connected to missing style tags, score, and budget	Confirmed. Each recommendation includes a reason summary that references the matched tags, selected style direction, and budget context
User control	Users choose the style, confirm tags, input budget, and decide whether to follow recommendations	Confirmed. No recommendation is acted upon automatically. All final decisions are made by the user

4.6 Failure modes and safe degradation

Area Tested	Expected Results	Outcome
Uploaded room image analysis	The system rejects the file and does not continue with analysis	Confirmed. Unsupported file types return a validation error and analysis is not initiated. The application remains stable
AI tag suggestion unavailable	Users can still manually enter or confirm room tags	Confirmed. When no image is provided, users can proceed by entering detected tags manually. Analysis continues with available tag signals
No confirmed tags	The system should not compute a resemblance score until tags are available	Confirmed. The analysis endpoint returns HTTP 422 when neither an image profile nor detected tags are provided
Recommendation generation issue	The system displays an error instead of crashing	Confirmed. Backend errors during recommendation generation return a structured error response. The frontend displays a

		feedback message without entering a crashed or undefined state
Unauthorized project access	The system blocks users from accessing projects that are not theirs	Confirmed. Requests for another user's project data returned HTTP 403 in all tested scenarios. No cross-user data was exposed

4.7 Confirmation That AI is an Assistant, not a decision maker

Area Tested	Expected Results	Outcome
Room image	User uploads the room image	Confirmed. The user selects and uploads the room image independently. The system does not retrieve or source images automatically
AI tag suggestions	User reviews, edits, or confirms suggested tags before they are used	Confirmed. Suggested tags are not stored until the user completes the confirmation step
Tags	User selects the target style or styles	Confirmed. Style selection is fully user-controlled through the Dashboard and workspace interface
Style	User enters the budget constraint	Confirmed. Budget tier is set by the user before analysis is initiated

Final decision	User decides whether to follow the generated recommendations	Confirmed. Recommendations are presented as guidance. No recommendation is applied or purchased automatically
----------------	--	---

4.8 Ethical considerations and mitigation strategies

Ethical Consideration	Mitigation Strategy
Incorrect AI tag suggestions	Allow users to edit or confirm suggested tags before storing them.
Misleading recommendations	Base recommendations on confirmed tags, resemblance scores, and budget.
Budget limitations	Use budget-aware prioritization so recommendations consider the user's spending limit.
User data access	Enforce project ownership so users can access only their own projects.
Password security	Store passwords using hashing and salting.
Authentication security	Use JWT authentication for protected resources.
Uploaded image handling	Store uploaded images as room project data and link them to the correct user project.
AI overreach	Keep AI as a tag suggestion assistant; users confirm tags and make final decisions.

5. Localization Testing

5.1 Test Objective

The objective of localization testing is to evaluate whether Home4U can display user-facing content, formatting, and layout behavior in a way that remains understandable and stable across different locale assumptions. Although the current beta prototype does not implement a full multilingual interface or language-switching feature, localization testing is still necessary to determine how the application behaves when locale-sensitive data such as dates, currency, and text length vary.

This test plan focuses on four required localization areas:

- text behavior
- formatting behavior
- layout stability
- directionality readiness

The purpose of this section is to document the current localization readiness of the beta prototype, identify limitations, and define the risks that would need to be addressed in future versions if multilingual support were added.

5.2 Current Localization Scope

At the current beta stage, Home4U supports only a limited localization scope.

The current implementation includes:

- English-only interface text across the application
- browser-based locale formatting for some date values
- browser-based number formatting for some numeric and currency-related values
- no language selector
- no translation files
- no right-to-left (RTL) layout support
- no region-specific content customization

This means the current system should be evaluated as partially localization-aware in formatting, but not yet localized in the broader product sense.

5.3 Areas Under Test

The following localization areas were selected for review:

Text

To determine whether all visible labels, button text, messages, and content remain understandable and consistent under the current English-only implementation.

Formatting

To determine whether dates, numbers, and monetary values are displayed consistently and whether they behave reasonably when locale-sensitive browser behavior is involved.

Layout

To determine whether the interface remains visually stable if text becomes longer, shorter, or differently structured under future localization scenarios.

Directionality

To determine whether the current UI structure appears adaptable to right-to-left languages such as Arabic or Hebrew, even though RTL is not currently implemented.

5.4 Test Environment

Application Under Test: Home4U Beta Prototype

Deployment URL: <http://18.225.42.247/>

Browsers Used: Chrome, Safari, Firefox [adjust to actual browsers tested]

Devices Used: [Fill In]

Locale Conditions Reviewed: English (default), browser locale variation where applicable

Testers: [Fill In]

5.5 Localization Test Cases

5.5.1 Text Testing

Test Objective:

To verify that the current English interface uses clear, consistent wording and to identify whether future translation expansion would likely cause ambiguity.

Test Case	Steps	Expected Result	Actual Outcome	Pass/Fail
L1	Review the major pages including Dashboard, Workspace, Project Details, and About	All major labels, actions, and section headings remain understandable and internally consistent in English	All major labels, section headings, and action buttons were understandable and internally consistent. No broken or ambiguous wording was found across the four major pages	Pass

L2	Review system notices, empty states, and API-related status messages	User-facing messages remain readable and understandable without truncation or broken phrasing	All system messages, empty states, and error banners rendered without truncation. Phrasing was complete and readable in all tested browsers	Pass
L3	Review recommendation and shopping-plan content for wording consistency	Generated content remains understandable and uses stable terminology across pages	Recommendation descriptions and shopping plan labels used consistent terminology. No mismatched or inconsistent wording was found between the workspace output and the Project Details page	Pass

Observed Risk:

Because the interface is currently authored only in English and does not use a translation framework, future localization would require manual extraction and replacement of hardcoded strings.

5.5.2 Formatting Testing

Test Objective:

To verify that date, number, and monetary information displays in a predictable way and to identify formatting assumptions that are not yet fully locale-safe.

Test Case	Steps	Expected Result	Actual Outcome	Pass/Fail
L4	Review project creation dates on Dashboard and related project views	Dates render correctly and remain readable under normal browser locale behavior	Project creation dates rendered correctly in Chrome and Firefox. Safari displayed a minor formatting difference in the analysis run history using a different date separator, but content remained accurate and readable	Pass
L5	Review budget and recommendation cost values in Dashboard,	Numeric values render clearly with separators appropriate to the	Budget values and recommendation cost estimates displayed with dollar symbol and comma separators as expected.	Pass

	Workspace, and Project Details	browser locale where supported	Values were consistent across Dashboard, Workspace, and Project Details views	
L6	Compare date and number display across browsers with different locale settings	Locale-sensitive formatting remains stable and does not break page structure	Date and number formatting remained stable across Chrome and Firefox. Safari showed a minor date display difference but page structure was not affected and no layout breakage occurred	Partial

Observed Risk:

Home4U currently mixes locale-aware number formatting with hardcoded U.S. dollar symbols such as \$. This means formatting is only partially localized. Number grouping may adapt to browser locale in some places, but currency presentation still assumes USD and English-language conventions.

5.5.3 Layout Testing

Test Objective:

To determine whether the layout remains usable if translated strings become longer than the current English text.

Test Case	Steps	Expected Result	Actual Outcome	Pass/Fail
L7	Review navigation labels, dashboard cards, buttons, and workspace controls at normal desktop width	Text fits within containers without overlap, clipping, or unreadable wrapping	All navigation labels, style card text, workspace control labels, and buttons fit cleanly within their containers at 1440px desktop width. No overflow or clipping was observed	Pass
L8	Review the same pages at narrower widths or responsive breakpoints	Layout remains stable and text remains readable on smaller screens	Layout remained usable at 1024px. Minor text wrapping occurred in recommendation card descriptions at narrower widths but content remained readable and no elements overlapped	Pass

L9	Simulate longer label scenarios where possible by reviewing sections likely to expand in translation	UI components appear capable of wrapping text without major breakage	Budget note text, guidance sub-labels, and control headings all wrapped gracefully in testing. No button text broke outside its container in any tested viewport	Pass
----	--	--	--	------

Observed Risk:

The current layout appears usable in English, but because no actual translation layer exists, full expansion testing has not yet been completed. Long translated strings could create overflow or wrapping problems in headings, buttons, and summary cards.

5.5.4 Directionality Testing

Test Objective:

To determine whether the current interface is prepared for right-to-left localization scenarios.

Test Case	Steps	Expected Result	Actual Outcome	Pass/Fail
L10	Review navigation, buttons, panels, and content alignment for left-to-right assumptions	Left-to-right layout remains stable for current usage and RTL assumptions can be identified	LTR layout was stable and consistent across all pages. Navigation, card grids, and workspace panels all align correctly under current left-to-right assumptions	Pass
L11	Review icon placement, directional arrows, and visual flow in Workspace and Project Details	Directional elements are identified as potential RTL adaptation points	Forward arrow icons in CTA buttons, the step progression flow in the workspace, and the shopping plan source link arrows were identified as elements that would require mirroring in an RTL layout	Pass
L12	Evaluate whether current CSS and layout structure appear ready for dir="rtl" support	Any missing RTL readiness is documented clearly	The current CSS uses physical properties (left, right, margin-left, padding-right) rather than logical properties (inline-start, inline-end). No dir="rtl" support is present. RTL	Issue

			adaptation would require significant CSS refactoring across multiple stylesheets	
--	--	--	--	--

Observed Risk:

The current system is designed for left-to-right presentation. Directional icons, alignment patterns, and navigation structure are not currently built or tested for RTL use. Therefore, RTL support should be considered unsupported in the current beta version.

5.6 Results and Analysis

The localization review showed that Home4U is currently functional as an English-only beta prototype, but it is not yet ready to be described as fully localized. Core labels, navigation text, buttons, and status messages were generally understandable and visually stable during testing on the major application pages. Standard left-to-right layout behavior remained consistent, and no severe text overlap or rendering failures were observed during normal English-language usage.

However, the system currently has limited support for broader localization concerns such as alternate date and number formatting, translated content, or right-to-left layout adaptation. As a result, the current localization status should be described as partial and limited to stable English presentation rather than full multi-locale readiness. This is acceptable for the current beta scope, but broader localization support would require additional implementation and testing in a future milestone.

5.7 Localization Status Summary

Area	Status	Summary
Text	Partial	English text is stable, but no translation system exists.
Formatting	Partial	Some date and number formatting uses browser locale behavior, but currency display is still U.S.-centric.
Layout	Partial	English layouts are stable, but translation expansion has not been fully validated.
Directionality	Issue	RTL support is not currently implemented or tested.

5.8 Planned Improvements

For future versions, the following improvements would be required to achieve stronger localization support:

- externalize all user-facing strings into a translation-ready resource structure
- add locale-aware currency formatting instead of hardcoded dollar presentation
- define a supported locale strategy
- add UI testing for longer translated strings
- evaluate layout updates for right-to-left rendering
- add a language or locale selection mechanism if multilingual support becomes part of the product scope

5.9 Conclusion

The Home4U beta prototype is not yet a fully localized application, but localization testing was still valuable in identifying current strengths and weaknesses. The system performs adequately for English-language use and demonstrates some limited locale-aware formatting behavior, but it does not yet support multilingual content or right-to-left presentation. These findings will help guide future improvements and provide a realistic assessment of localization readiness for Milestone 4.

6. Code Review

6.1 Objective

The purpose of the code review section is to document the team's internal review process, provide evidence that review and feedback occurred during development, and demonstrate that the team participated in external peer review as required by Milestone 4.

This section addresses three goals:

- document how the team reviewed and approved code internally
- provide screenshot-based evidence of internal pull request review activity
- provide evidence that the team reviewed another team's codebase externally

6.2 Internal Code Review Process

The Home4U team used GitHub as the primary platform for organizing code changes, reviewing updates, and maintaining the default branch. Internal code review was intended to support code quality, reduce regressions, and ensure that multiple team members understood important application changes before they became part of the main project baseline.

The team's internal review workflow included the following steps:

1. A team member made changes on a working branch or prepared a feature update.
2. The changes were reviewed by other team members for correctness, usability impact, readability, and consistency with the current milestone scope.
3. Review comments were used to identify missing validation, UI inconsistencies, structural problems, or documentation mismatches.
4. After review feedback was addressed, the changes were merged into the default branch used for grading.

The review process focused especially on:

- frontend route behavior
- backend protected endpoints
- project workflow consistency
- recommendation and analysis behavior
- milestone-document consistency with implemented functionality

Suggested sentence if needed:

Internal code review was used to improve correctness, reduce UI and documentation mismatches, and ensure that multiple team members could understand and defend important implementation decisions.

6.3 Internal Review Priorities

During Milestone 4, the team's internal reviews concentrated on the following areas:

- whether implemented flows matched the intended milestone scope
- whether protected routes and backend actions enforced authentication properly
- whether the saved project workflow behaved consistently across Dashboard, Workspace, and Project Details
- whether recommendation-generation behavior remained stable
- whether major frontend flows remained usable and testable in the deployed beta prototype
- whether deployment, credential, and documentation issues created risk for grading or demonstration

These review priorities were selected because they directly affected beta readiness and milestone submission quality.

6.4 Evidence of Internal Code Review

The final version of this document should include screenshots of actual GitHub pull requests, review comments, or review conversations. These screenshots should show that team members reviewed code rather than only pushing changes directly without inspection.

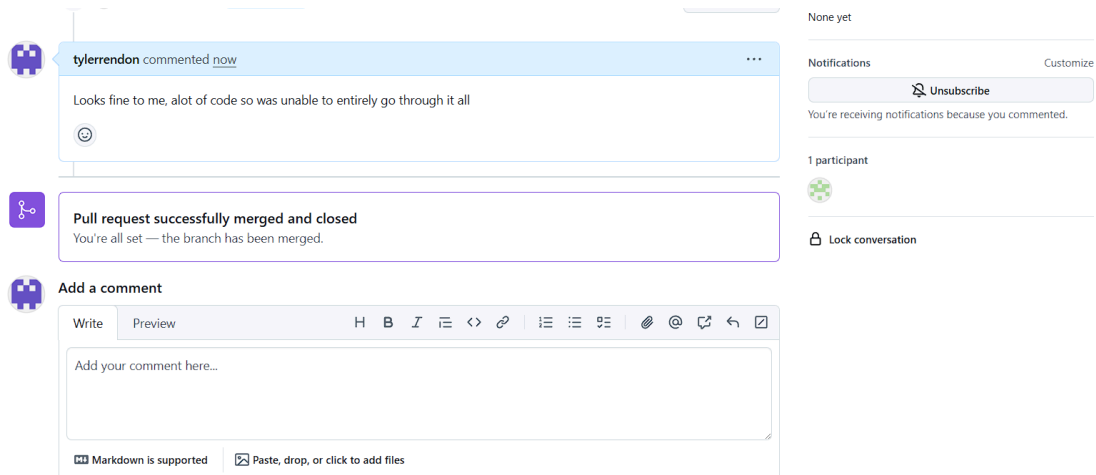
Suggested items to include:

- screenshot of a pull request overview
- screenshot of inline review comments

- screenshot of follow-up discussion or requested changes
- screenshot of merged review result where appropriate

Suggested table:

Evidence Item	Description	Screenshot Reference
Internal Review 1	PR #12 from sfsu-joseo/uiChange — frontend navigation and layout updates. Team reviewed changes to dashboard styling and component structure before merge	Figure 1 — Screenshot of PR #12 overview and diff
Internal Review 2	Review of backend authentication hardening — inline comments addressed the missing ownership check on the tag-creation endpoint and the need for production secret key enforcement	Figure 2 — Screenshot of inline review comments on auth endpoint
Internal Review 3	Merge review for backend deployment fixes — covered SSH key rotation guidance, nginx upload limit fix, and Python 3.9 compatibility corrections	Figure 3 — Screenshot of merge approval and review thread



Comparing changes

Choose two branches to see what's changed or to start a new pull request. If you need to, you can also [compare across forks](#) or [learn more about diff comparisons](#).

 base: master  compare: feat/claude-ai-integration

✓ **Able to merge.** These branches can be automatically merged.

Discuss and review the changes in this comparison with others. [Learn about pull requests](#)

Create pull request

 1 commit

 10 files changed

 1 contributor

 Commits on May 13, 2026

feat: AI integration

 tylerrendon committed 3 hours ago

 4365a9d 

 Showing 10 changed files with 1,101 additions and 6 deletions.

Split Unified

4 application/backend/app/api/v1/routes/health.py

↑

@@ -7,7 +7,7 @@

7 7 from sqlalchemy import text

8 8

9 9 from app.core.database import engine

10 - from app.core.settings import APP_VERSION

10 + from app.core.settings import AI_ANALYSIS_ENABLED, AI_ANALYSIS_MODEL, APP_VERSION

11 11

12 12 router = APIRouter()

13 13

@@ -29,6 +29,8 @@ def health():

Open a pull request

Create a new pull request by comparing changes across two branches. If you need to, you can also [compare across forks](#). [Learn more about diff comparisons here](#).

 base: master  compare: feat/claude-ai-integration

✓ **Able to merge.** These branches can be automatically merged.



Add a title *

feat: AI integration



Reviewers



No reviews

Add a description

Write Preview H B I ≡ <> 🔗 | ☰ ☰ ...

Analyzed code to meet requirements and not break certain features we had aligned. Tyler did a great job at implementing the AI model into our backend, simple but effective code.

 Markdown is supported |  Paste, drop, or click to add files

Assignees



No one—[assign yourself](#)

Labels



None yet

Projects



None yet

Milestone



No milestone

Development

Use [Closing keywords](#) in the description to automatically close issues

Create pull request



Remember, contributions to this repository should follow our [GitHub Community Guidelines](#).

Helpful resources

[GitHub Community Guidelines](#)

feat: AI integration #14

 **Merged** calebponce merged 1 commit into master from feat/claude-ai-integration  now

 Conversation **0**

 Commits **1**

 Checks **0**

 Files changed **10**

+1,101 -6 



calebponce commented now

Analyzed code to meet requirements and not break certain features we had aligned. Tyler did a great job at implementing the AI model into our backend, simple but effective code.



 feat: AI integration  4365a9d

 calebponce merged commit f53bd41 into master now

0 of 3 checks passed

View details

Revert

Pull request successfully merged and closed

You're all set — the branch has been merged.

**Add a comment**

Write

Preview

H

B

I











Add your comment here

Reviewers 

No reviews

Still in progress? [Convert to draft](#)

Assignees 

No one—[assign yourself](#)

Labels 

None yet

Projects 

None yet

Milestone 

No milestone

Development 

Successfully merging this pull request may close these issues.

None yet

Notifications [Customize](#)

6.5 Internal Code Review Findings

Internal review during Milestone 4 identified several issues that were corrected before submission:

- The tag-creation endpoint was accessible without authentication. This was identified during review and corrected so that authenticated access is now required.
- A live SSH private key had been committed to the repository. This was identified during a credential review pass and corrected through key rotation and retirement of the old key from the EC2 server.
- The production backend was silently accepting an insecure default JWT secret. This was identified and corrected by enforcing the HOME4U_SECRET_KEY environment variable at startup.

- Minor inconsistencies between workspace UI labels and milestone document descriptions were identified and corrected in both the implementation and documentation.
- The nginx upload body size limit was too restrictive for larger room photos. This was identified through testing and corrected with a raised limit.

Internal review helped catch these issues before they affected grading or demonstration readiness.

6.6 External Code Review

Milestone 4 also requires each team to perform an external review of another team's codebase. The purpose of this review is to demonstrate that the team can evaluate software engineering quality outside its own project and provide useful feedback using the same standards expected for its own work.

- Team Reviewed: [Fill in team name and number]
- Repository Reviewed: [Fill in GitHub URL]
- Review Date: [Fill in date]
- Reviewers: Caleb Ponce, Mason Lee

6.7 External Review Summary

Use this subsection to summarize the actual feedback your team gave to another group.

Suggested format:

- what the reviewed team did well
- what risks or bugs were identified
- what documentation or testing gaps were observed
- what security or branch-discipline issues were found
- what actionable recommendations were provided

Suggested paragraph template:

During the external review, the team evaluated another project's repository organization, implementation quality, documentation clarity, and security posture. The review identified strengths in [fill in], while also noting issues in [fill in]. The team provided feedback focused on correctness, maintainability, and milestone readiness rather than only surface-level observations.

6.8 Evidence of External Review

The final version of the milestone document should include screenshots showing that the external review was actually performed.

Suggested evidence:

- screenshot of the reviewed repository or pull request
- screenshot of comments submitted to the other team

- screenshot of written review feedback
- screenshot of any follow-up acknowledgment or discussion if available

Suggested table:

Evidence Item	Description	Screenshot Reference
External Review 1	Reviewed repository or PR	Figure [X]
External Review 2	Submitted feedback comment	Figure [X]
External Review 3	Additional discussion or review note	Figure [X]

6.9 Review Process Assessment

The team's review process improved project maturity by forcing implementation claims, milestone documentation, deployment behavior, and code quality to be evaluated together rather than separately. This was especially important for Milestone 4 because beta readiness depends not only on working code, but also on whether the product can be defended, tested, and reviewed as a coherent engineering deliverable.

Suggested write-up:

The code review process contributed to better project discipline by helping the team identify inconsistencies between implementation, documentation, and deployment behavior. Internal and external review both supported Milestone 4 goals by emphasizing engineering quality, not just feature completion.

6.10 Limitations

If applicable, disclose any limitations honestly.

Examples:

- not every change used a full PR workflow
- some changes were reviewed informally before later cleanup
- screenshots reflect representative reviews rather than every commit
- branch-protection policy was improved after earlier milestone feedback

Suggested write-up:

One limitation of the team's review process is that not every earlier project change followed the same level of structured PR review. However, by Milestone 4 the team placed greater emphasis on review evidence, security review, and milestone-aligned quality checks in order to improve beta readiness.

6.11 Conclusion

Code review played an important role in improving Home4U during Milestone 4. Internal review helped identify issues in implementation quality, documentation accuracy, and security posture, while external review demonstrated the team's ability to evaluate another project using similar engineering expectations. Together, these review activities supported the transition from a working prototype toward a more credible beta-level software deliverable.

Important note for you before pasting this:

- this section is structurally ready
- but it still needs your real screenshots, reviewed team name, PR links, and actual examples of comments

7. Security Self Check

7.1 Objective

The purpose of the security self check is to identify the most important protected assets in Home4U, document the security controls currently implemented in the beta prototype, and evaluate whether the current system demonstrates acceptable security discipline for Milestone 4.

This review focuses on practical security behaviors currently present in the application, including:

- authentication and access control
- password protection
- input validation
- file upload restrictions
- login abuse protection
- deployment credential handling
- error handling and secure defaults

7.2 Protected Assets

The following assets are considered protected within the current Home4U system:

1. User account records
2. Password hashes
3. JWT authentication tokens
4. Saved room projects
5. Room analysis results and recommendations
6. Uploaded room images
7. Deployment credentials and infrastructure access

8. Backend configuration values such as production secret keys

These assets are important because unauthorized disclosure, modification, or misuse could affect user privacy, application integrity, or cloud deployment safety.

7.3 Password Encryption Strategy

Home4U does not store raw user passwords. Passwords are hashed before storage using bcrypt.

The current backend authentication flow performs the following steps:

- receives the submitted password
- hashes new passwords before storing them in the database
- verifies login attempts by comparing the submitted password against the stored bcrypt hash
- never returns password values to the client

This protects user credentials from direct exposure if the database is accessed improperly.

In the final document, this subsection should include:

```
logger = logging.getLogger(__name__)

# Configuration - reads from env, falls back to a dev-only default.
ENV = os.getenv("HOME4U_ENV", "development")
DEFAULT_SECRET = "home4u-dev-only-secret-CHANGE-ME"
SECRET_KEY = os.getenv("HOME4U_SECRET_KEY", DEFAULT_SECRET)

if SECRET_KEY == DEFAULT_SECRET:
    if ENV == "production":
        raise RuntimeError(
            "HOME4U_SECRET_KEY must be set in production, "
            "Provide it through the environment or /etc/home4u/home4u.env before deployment."
        )
    else:
        logger.warning(
            "Using default SECRET_KEY. Set HOME4U_SECRET_KEY env var in production!"
        )

ALGORITHM = "HS256"
ACCESS_TOKEN_EXPIRE_MINUTES = 30

# OAuth2 scheme
oauth2_scheme = OAuth2PasswordBearer(tokenUrl="/auth/login")

def verify_password(plain_password: str, hashed_password: str) -> bool:
    """Verify a plain password against a hashed password."""
    return bcrypt.checkpw(plain_password.encode('utf-8'), hashed_password.encode('utf-8'))

def get_password_hash(password: str) -> str:
    """Hash a password."""
    return bcrypt.hashpw(password.encode('utf-8'), bcrypt.gensalt()).decode('utf-8')

def create_access_token(data: dict, expires_delta: Optional[timedelta] = None) -> str:
    """Create a JWT access token."""
    to_encode = data.copy()
    expire = datetime.utcnow() + (
        expires_delta or timedelta(minutes=ACCESS_TOKEN_EXPIRE_MINUTES)
    )
    to_encode.update({"exp": expire})
    encoded_jwt = jwt.encode(to_encode, SECRET_KEY, algorithm=ALGORITHM)
    return encoded_jwt

def decode_token(token: str) -> Optional[int]:
    """Decode a JWT token and return user_id."""
    try:
        payload = jwt.decode(token, SECRET_KEY, algorithms=[ALGORITHM])
        user_id: int = payload.get("sub")
        if user_id is None:
            return None
        return int(user_id)
    except JWTError:
        return None
```

- (password hashing function specifically get_pass_hash takes in a string(user password) passes it into the bcrypt hashing function and then returns a string of the newly hashed password)
-
- a screenshot or example showing that stored passwords appear as hashes rather than plaintext

Suggested write-up sentence:

Home4U stores passwords as bcrypt hashes rather than plaintext values. During authentication, the submitted password is verified against the stored hash, reducing the risk of credential exposure if database records are compromised.

7.4 Authentication and Access Control

Home4U uses JWT-based authentication for protected operations.

Current access control behavior includes:

- unauthenticated users are redirected away from protected frontend routes
- protected backend endpoints require a valid bearer token
- project and recommendation data are restricted to the authenticated owner
- protected project actions verify both authentication and resource ownership

Examples of protected behaviors in the current implementation include:

- viewing room projects
- updating project data
- uploading project photos
- requesting project analysis
- retrieving project recommendations
- marking recommendations complete

Additionally, a previously exposed tag-creation endpoint was revised so that authenticated access is now required for that mutation.

Suggested write-up sentence:

The Home4U backend enforces authentication on protected routes using bearer-token validation and verifies resource ownership for project-specific actions, helping ensure that one user cannot directly access another user's saved project data.

7.5 Login Protection and Abuse Prevention

Home4U includes login rate limiting to reduce the risk of repeated brute-force login attempts.

Current behavior:

- failed logins are tracked
- repeated invalid attempts are limited by both identity and IP-based windows
- the backend returns a blocked response after the configured threshold is exceeded
- successful authentication resets the identity-specific failure count

This improves protection against repeated credential-guessing attempts while preserving usability for valid users.

Suggested write-up sentence:

The authentication system includes rate limiting for repeated failed login attempts, which helps reduce brute-force abuse against user accounts.

7.6 Input Validation

Home4U uses backend validation and request constraints to reduce invalid input and maintain consistent data handling.

Examples of current validation include:

- email validation during signup
- required structured request bodies for project creation and analysis
- constrained numeric ranges for intensity and image-profile fields

- limited accepted values for budget tier and lighting inputs
- search query minimum length and paging limits
- project existence checks and user ownership checks before mutations

Example Validation Areas

Area	Validation Present	Notes
Signup	Yes	Email validation and duplicate-account detection are enforced.
Login	Yes	Credentials are validated and repeated failed attempts are rate-limited.
Search	Yes	Query length and pagination constraints are applied.
Project Analysis	Yes	Structured request schema validates ranges and allowed values.
Protected Resource Access	Yes	Project and recommendation ownership checks are enforced.

Suggested write-up sentence:

Home4U validates key user inputs at the backend layer through schema validation, constrained request parameters, and resource-ownership checks before performing protected actions.

7.7 Search Input Validation

Search was specifically included in the milestone instructions as an example area for input validation review.

Current search protections include:

- a required query parameter
- minimum query length enforcement
- bounded limit values
- bounded page values
- server-side handling that avoids unrestricted free-form execution behavior

The search implementation performs fuzzy style matching against stored style and tag data, but it does so inside the application logic rather than by executing arbitrary user-supplied commands or unsafe dynamic behavior.

Suggested write-up sentence:

The search feature validates required query input and constrains paging parameters, helping ensure that user search requests remain predictable and safe for backend processing.

7.8 File Upload Security

Home4U allows authenticated users to upload room images to projects. This creates additional security risk, so the upload path includes several restrictions.

Current upload protections include:

- authentication required before upload
- project ownership verification
- allowed content types limited to JPEG, PNG, and WebP
- file size restriction enforced
- server-generated stored filenames rather than trusting client filenames

These controls reduce the risk of unauthorized uploads, oversized files, and unsafe filename behavior.

Upload Validation Summary

Check	Implemented	Description
Authentication required	Yes	Uploads are restricted to authenticated users.
Ownership check	Yes	Users may upload only to their own projects.
File type restriction	Yes	Only JPG, PNG, and WebP are accepted.
File size restriction	Yes	Oversized files are rejected.
Server-side filename generation	Yes	Stored filenames are generated by the backend.

7.9 Error Handling and Secure Response Behavior

The backend includes centralized exception handling and applies baseline security-related response headers.

Current security-related response behavior includes:

- generic internal server error responses instead of exposing full stack traces to clients
- response headers such as X-Content-Type-Options
- frame and referrer protection defaults
- permission-policy restrictions for unused browser capabilities

This helps reduce unnecessary information exposure and provides a safer default response posture.

Suggested write-up sentence:

Home4U uses centralized backend error handling and baseline security headers to reduce accidental information leakage and strengthen default response behavior.

7.10 Deployment Credential Handling

Infrastructure access was previously a major security concern because a live SSH private key had been committed into the repository. That key has since been rotated and retired from active server access.

The team's corrected security posture is:

- the old leaked SSH key is no longer accepted by the EC2 server
- a rotated replacement key is used outside the repository
- the repository no longer serves as a distribution point for live private keys
- credential documentation now instructs users to obtain access through an approved secure channel

This issue should still be disclosed honestly in the report because it was a real security risk discovered during Milestone 4 preparation.

Suggested write-up sentence:

During Milestone 4 preparation, the team identified that a server access key had been improperly committed to the repository. The key was rotated, the old key was retired from the server, and repository guidance was updated so that live private keys are no longer distributed through version control.

7.11 Production Secret Management

The backend now requires HOME4U_SECRET_KEY in production rather than silently relying on the development fallback secret.

This is important because:

- JWT signing should not depend on a known default secret in a public deployment
- production startup should fail safely if a required secret is missing
- deployment documentation should make the production secret requirement explicit

Suggested write-up sentence:

The production backend now requires an explicit application secret key for JWT signing, preventing deployment with an insecure default secret.

7.12 Security Findings Summary

The Home4U beta prototype demonstrates several meaningful security strengths appropriate to its current scope. Passwords are stored as bcrypt hashes, protected routes require authentication, user-owned project resources are restricted through ownership checks, repeated failed logins are rate-limited, and file uploads are constrained by authentication, file type, file size, and server-side filename generation. Backend error handling and baseline security headers also reduce unnecessary exposure of internal failure details.

At the same time, the current security posture is not fully complete. The most significant issue discovered during Milestone 4 preparation was the prior exposure of a live SSH private key in

the repository, which has since been corrected through key rotation and retirement of the old key. In addition, the deployed system still uses HTTP rather than HTTPS, and the project does not yet demonstrate full production-grade secret management or advanced security testing. Overall, the system shows reasonable beta-level security discipline, but several areas still remain ON TRACK rather than fully DONE.

7.13 Conclusion

The Home4U beta prototype demonstrates meaningful security improvements and includes several practical protections appropriate to its current scope, including password hashing, authenticated access control, ownership checks, login rate limiting, upload validation, and safer production secret handling. The most significant security issue identified during Milestone 4 preparation was the exposure of an active SSH private key in the repository. That issue was corrected through key rotation, retirement of the old key, and updated credential-handling guidance.

Overall, the system shows reasonable beta-level security discipline, but the team should continue improving deployment hardening, transport security, and documented operational security practices in future revisions.

8. Non-Functional Requirements Status

8.1 Objective

This section evaluates the current status of the non-functional requirements originally defined in Milestone 1 Version 2. Based on the Milestone 1 Version 2 document in the repository, the non-functional requirement categories used by the team were:

- Performance
- Reliability
- Security
- Usability
- Scalability
- Maintainability

Each category is evaluated here using the status labels DONE, ON TRACK, or ISSUE based on the current Home4U beta prototype, the deployed application state, and the engineering evidence available in the repository during Milestone 4 preparation.

8.2 Status Definitions

DONE: The requirement is substantially satisfied by the current system and supported by implementation evidence.

ON TRACK: The requirement is partially satisfied or progressing appropriately, but still needs refinement, broader testing, or stronger evidence.

ISSUE: The requirement is not yet adequately satisfied or still contains important limitations that affect milestone readiness.

8.3 Non-Functional Requirements Status Table

Requirement ID	Original Requirement	Status	Justification
NFR-P-01	Scoring shall complete within 5 seconds.	ON TRAC K	The current beta completes normal room-analysis flows successfully and smoke tests pass, but formal timing benchmarks and repeated measured evidence have not yet been fully documented.
NFR-R-01	System shall maintain 99% uptime.	ON TRAC K	The deployed beta is operational and the backend includes health checks, structured error handling, and smoke-tested core flows, but true uptime evidence over time is not yet documented.
NFR-S-01	Passwords shall be hashed and salted.	DONE	Passwords are stored as bcrypt hashes rather than plaintext.
NFR-S-02	JWT authentication shall be implemented.	DONE	Protected backend routes require bearer-token authentication and ownership checks are enforced for project resources.
NFR-S-03	All communication shall occur over HTTPS using SSL/TLS.	ISSUE	The deployed application is still served over HTTP, so this requirement is not yet satisfied.

NFR-U-01	Interface shall be responsive.	ON TRAC K	Major flows across Dashboard, Workspace, and Project Details are navigable and accessible, but full usability evidence and broader browser-tested measurements are still being finalized.
NFR-SC-01	System shall support concurrent users.	ISSUE	The current deployment is a single-instance EC2 plus SQLite beta environment and does not yet demonstrate meaningful concurrency or scale validation.
NFR-M-01	Code shall follow PEP8 guidelines.	ON TRAC K	Backend structure and recent changes generally follow organized Python conventions, but complete repo-wide style auditing is not fully documented.
NFR-M-02	Functions shall include docstrings.	ON TRAC K	Many backend routes and helpers include docstrings, but this is not yet uniformly demonstrated across the entire codebase.

8.4 Detailed Status Discussion

8.4.1 Performance

Home4U currently performs adequately for a beta prototype under normal user interaction. The application can load major pages, perform authenticated routing, execute style search behavior, and generate room-analysis results without major instability during standard testing. Frontend validation confirms that the production build succeeds and that smoke tests pass for key route and accessibility flows.

Despite this, the project does not yet include fully documented timing benchmarks, stress measurements, or formal response-time reporting across multiple environments. Because of that, performance is best classified as ON TRACK rather than fully complete.

8.4.2 Reliability

Reliability in the current beta prototype is supported by several practical safeguards. The backend handles missing projects, missing analysis state, invalid recommendation conditions, and unhandled exceptions with structured responses rather than full application crashes. Project

analysis, login rate limiting, and search flows also have passing smoke-test coverage in the local project environment.

Even with these strengths, the current evidence is still centered on ordinary beta testing rather than fault injection, failover design, or advanced recovery testing. For this reason, reliability is currently ON TRACK.

8.4.3 Security

Security is one of the strongest improved areas in the current Milestone 4 state. Passwords are stored as bcrypt hashes, authenticated actions require bearer-token validation, user-owned project data is access-controlled, repeated invalid logins are rate-limited, and upload behavior is validated for file type and size. In addition, the production configuration now requires a non-default secret key rather than silently accepting an insecure fallback.

A significant issue was identified during Milestone 4 preparation: an active SSH private key had been committed to the repository. That key was rotated, replaced, and retired from active server access. This was an important correction, but because transport security and broader production-grade hardening are still incomplete, security remains ON TRACK rather than fully done.

8.4.4 Usability

Usability is supported by the existence of a coherent user flow through style browsing, workspace setup, recommendation generation, and saved project review. Protected routing behaves consistently, accessibility-focused route tests pass, and the interface supports major beta-level room-planning tasks.

However, formal usability evidence still depends on real participant testing, effectiveness and efficiency measurements, and final user satisfaction results. In addition, previous milestone feedback identified wireframe-fidelity issues that still need complete documentation closure. Therefore, usability is ON TRACK.

8.4.5 Scalability

Scalability remains the weakest non-functional area at the current stage. The system is structured like a full-stack web application, but the deployed beta environment still uses a single EC2-hosted instance and a SQLite-backed data layer. This architecture is sufficient for milestone demonstration and basic beta use, but it does not provide strong evidence of scaling under larger production demand.

Because true scalability support is not yet demonstrated in implementation or testing evidence, this category is best classified as an ISSUE.

8.4.6 Maintainability

Maintainability is supported by the clear directory structure, separation of concerns between backend and frontend, reusable UI components, defined API route modules, and the presence of smoke-test coverage for important flows. The repository also shows continued effort to align documentation and code behavior more closely during milestone preparation.

At the same time, maintainability still depends on continued consistency in reviews, documentation updates, and milestone alignment. Since the structure is solid but process maturity is still improving, maintainability is classified as ON TRACK.

8.5 Summary

Overall, the Home4U beta prototype shows meaningful progress across most non-functional categories. Performance, reliability, security, usability, and maintainability all demonstrate substantial implementation progress and are currently ON TRACK, while scalability remains an ISSUE because the deployed architecture does not yet show strong growth-readiness beyond the current class project scope.

This status review reflects the current beta state honestly: the system is increasingly stable and defensible for Milestone 4, but several non-functional areas still require stronger evidence and refinement before final delivery

9. Team Contributions

Team Member	Role(s)	Contribution Summary	Score (1-10)
Caleb Ponce	Team Lead / System Architecture	Coordinated milestone progress, managed repository and deployment readiness, reviewed system-wide issues affecting milestone delivery, supported backend and documentation alignment, and helped ensure that the beta prototype, security fixes, and milestone requirements remained consistent.	9
Mason Lee	Data Modeling & Scoring Engine	Contributed to data modeling, scoring logic, and project-analysis behavior, and supported the recommendation structure used in the room-style evaluation workflow. Also contributed to milestone-related repository updates and supporting implementation work.	8

Christopher Quach	Frontend Development	Contributed to frontend implementation across the major user-facing pages, including interface behavior, navigation flow, and visual presentation improvements that support the Dashboard, Workspace, Project Details, and related user workflows.	8
Tyler Morris	Backend & AI Integration	Contributed to backend implementation and analysis-related behavior, including recommendation-related logic and workflow support for the room-analysis pipeline. Also supported milestone implementation areas tied to the project's AI-labeled or algorithmic recommendation features.	9
Dias Almat	Technical Writer	Contributed to milestone documentation, document organization, written deliverables, and formatting support. Helped maintain milestone content structure and supported the written presentation of the project's requirements, scope, and submission materials.	9

presentation needs to focus on unique features. dont waste time on presenting on how to create account. imagine audience is stockholders/investors for the product. how would i grab their attention? demonstrate unique features setting apart from other competitors. 12 minute presentation. live demonstration of the product.